

Franchise Auction

The owner's guide: how to bid, what your purse can reach, and every command the room can use.

Who this is for — franchise owners and co-owners who will be bidding, and anybody in the auction group who wants to follow it. You need no admin rights for anything in this guide. If you are **running** the auction, read the admin guide instead.

What is in here

- Money: crore, lakh, and why a bare number is crore
- Bidding: the one command you will actually use
- Reading the board, and the three views worth knowing
- What your purse can really reach (the max-bid rule)
- Every rule that can refuse your bid, and what it means
- Retention and Right To Match, if your auction uses them
- Focus mode: why the group answers nothing else while a lot is live
- Homework: what to read in a DM the night before
- The whole command list, on one page

Every number in this guide is the shipped default. All of them are set per auction, and `/arules` in the auction's group prints what this one actually uses.

1. The shape of an auction

An admin builds a player pool and a field of franchises. Each franchise has an **owner** and any number of **co-owners**, and a **purse** to spend. Players then go on the block one at a time, as **lots**, in sets; the room bids; the highest bid when the clock runs out wins, and the price comes off that franchise's purse. When the pool is finished the admin publishes the squads, and the auction becomes a real league you play in.

Three things are worth knowing before your first lot:

- **Auction money is its own currency.** A purse cannot buy anything else in the bot, and your coins are worth nothing at an auction. The two never meet.
- **You bid for your franchise, not for yourself.** An owner and a co-owner are equals: either can bid, and both spend the same purse.
- **Bidding only works in the auction's group.** That is deliberate — a bid nobody in the room saw is how a price gets disputed. Reading works in a DM too.

2. Money: a bare number is crore

Every amount is read as **crore** unless you say lakh out loud. This is how the room talks, so it is how the bot listens:

/bid 15	→ ₹15 Cr
/bid 1.5	→ ₹1.5 Cr (₹150 lakh)
/bid 75L	→ ₹75 lakh
/bid 75 lakh	→ ₹75 lakh

Every prompt the bot prints shows the next minimum in the same form, so the commonest move is typing back the number it just showed you.

3. Bidding

Bare /bid bids the next minimum. That is the one you will use most, and the one that cannot be fat-fingered with ten seconds on the clock. /bd is the short alias.

/bid	→ the next legal minimum, whatever it is
/bid 2.4	→ ₹2.4 Cr, if that clears the minimum
/bd 2.4	→ the same thing, fewer letters

The pinned board also carries **quick-bid buttons**. They are shared, not locked to one franchise — a board the second franchise cannot touch is not an auction. Each press is checked against the franchise **you** own, and the exact price is baked into the button, so a stale board can never bid a number nobody meant.

A bid that works gets no reply. Forty bids inside one lot would be forty messages on top of a board you are trying to read. Your message gets a reaction, and the board carries the new price within a tick (two seconds).

A bid that is refused always answers, and always names the number that would have worked instead. On a thirty-second clock, “invalid bid” is useless.

The one thing you cannot do is **bid against yourself**: if you are already the top bidder, a raise is refused. (The single exception is a Right To Match window, where the top bidder is invited to raise their own bid once — see section 8.)

One pair of hands per franchise, per lot

Owner and co-owners are equals — but not at the same moment. **Whoever bids first for a franchise holds that lot**, and the other one is refused by name until the next lot:

“Alice is bidding for Mumbai on this lot — only one of you at a time, or you end up raising each other. The next lot is open to either of you.”

Two co-owners bidding the same player is not two tactics; it is one franchise racing itself up its own price, and the loser of that race is always the franchise. The claim clears the moment the lot does, so the next player is open to either of you again — and if an admin undoes the bid that claimed it, so does the claim.

Direct bids, if your auction allows them

Some rooms run a strict ladder. If your admin has turned **direct bids off**, a typed amount is refused, and the message names the number it would have been:

```
/bid 12 → Direct bids are off in this auction
        → Send /bid on its own to bid ₹2.4 Cr
```

Bare /bid and the board's buttons still work, so you can always bid — one step at a time. /arules says which way your auction is set.

4. The clock

- A lot stays on the block for **30 seconds** by default, and **every bid restarts it**.
- At 10 seconds left the room hears **going once**, at 5 seconds **going twice**.
- **Anti-snipe**: a bid landing inside the last few seconds pushes the clock back out, a limited number of times per lot. Many rooms set it to “any bid in the last 10 seconds gives everybody 10 more”. /arules prints the exact numbers your auction uses.
- The deadline is decided by the bot, not by the announcement: a bid that arrives after time is refused by the command itself, even if the room has not been told yet.

An admin can add time with /aextend — a dropped connection is not a snipe, so that does not spend the anti-snipe budget.

5. What your purse can actually reach

Your purse is not your maximum bid. The auction holds back enough to fill the squad slots you still owe, so you cannot spend your way into an illegal squad:

```
slots you would still owe = min squad - (squad + 1)
reserve                  = slots × cheapest base price
max bid                  = purse remaining - reserve
```

So a franchise one player short of the squad minimum may spend its last rupee — there are no slots left to protect. A franchise five short cannot. **This number is printed for you**: on the board, in /apurse and in /asquad. It is not a suggestion; a bid above it is refused.

Why it is a rule and not advice

A minimum squad size that was only checked at the end would be a complaint nobody could act on — the money would already be gone. Refusing the bid while there is still a slot to fix the problem with is the only version you can plan around.

6. Everything that can refuse a bid

In the order they are checked, each with its own message naming the number that would have worked:

Refusal	What it means
Not live	The auction is paused, nothing is on the block, or the clock has run out.
You lead already	You are the top bidder. You cannot raise your own bid.
Too small	Below the base price, or below the standing bid plus the next increment. The message prints the minimum.
Squad full	Winning this lot would take you past the maximum squad size.
Purse	You do not have the money.
Reachability	You have the money, but winning at that price would leave you unable to fill your remaining minimum slots at base price. See section 5.
Overseas cap	Too many players from outside the auction's home country.
Role rule	Either a role ceiling (an eighth bowler in a seven-bowler squad) or a role minimum you would no longer be able to reach.

Bid increments step up as the price climbs — ten lakh on top of ₹18 Cr is noise, and forty of those is a room falling asleep. `/arules` prints the whole ladder; a bare `/bid` always uses the right step for the current price.

7. The views worth knowing

None of these are in the slash menu (both menus are full at Telegram's 100-command ceiling), so they are listed here and behind `/ainfo`'s buttons.

Every card is yours, and closes. A card you asked for carries a Close button that takes it out of the chat — useful in a group where the board is the message everyone is trying to read — and only you can press it. The `/ainfo` menu and the Sets card work the same way: they answer the person who sent the command, so if somebody else's card ignores your taps, send the command yourself for a copy of your own. The **pinned board** is the exception on both counts — its quick-bid buttons belong to the whole room, and it cannot be closed.

Command	What you get
<code>/aboard</code>	A personal copy of the live board, with quick-bid buttons. In a DM it comes without the buttons, since a bid outside the group is refused anyway.
<code>/ainfo</code>	Where the auction stands, plus a button for every view below. Start here if you remember nothing else.

Command	What you get
/arules	Every number this auction runs by: purse, squad and overseas caps, role limits, base prices band by band, the bid ladder, the clock, retention, RTM, picks.
/apurse	Every franchise's purse, max bid and squad count (and RTM cards left). /apurse Mumbai for one of them.
/asquad	Your own squad as a table, with purse and max bid. /asquad Mumbai for somebody else's.
/assets	Every set and its state. /anextset for the next set's players, /anextplayer for who is up next.
/asoldlist	Everyone sold so far, set by set.
/aunsoldlist	Everyone unsold, including the accelerated set.
/aretlock	Who has kept whom, and whether the retention window is still open.
/apicks	The expansion pick order and whose turn it is.

8. Retention and Right To Match

Not every auction uses these. /arules shows them only when yours does.

Retention happens before the first lot opens: a franchise keeps some of the players it already had, at a price off the top of its purse. An admin **offers** the retention and **your franchise accepts it** — the Accept button on that card works only for that franchise's owner and co-owners. Nobody else can press it, admins included. A retained player is on your squad from that moment, and counts against every cap.

Right To Match (RTM) lets last season's franchise take a player back at the price the room set. It runs as three short windows on one clock:

- 1 The **holder** (last season's franchise) is asked whether it wants to exercise the right at all.
- 2 If it does, the **top bidder** gets one last raise — and this is the one moment you may raise your own bid — or may stand.
- 3 The **holder** then matches that final number, or lets the player go.

You answer with one verb, whichever question is on the clock:

```
/artm yes      → exercise it / match it
/artm no       → decline / let him go
/artm stand    → (top bidder) no further raise
```

Every window times out to the **safe** answer — decline, stand, decline — so a silent owner can never wedge the auction. The prompt names the owner and carries buttons, so you do not have to remember the command.

9. Focus mode: the group runs one thing at a time

While the auction is **live or paused**, its group answers auction commands and **nothing else**. Try anything else and you get one line back:

“ **Season 2** is on the block. Only auction commands work in this group while it runs — /bid, /ainfo, /aboard, /apurse and the rest of the a-commands. Everything else still works in a DM with me.”

The reason is the board: a thirty-second clock and a pinned message being edited every two seconds cannot share a room with a /claim card, and a bid that scrolls past unseen is how a price gets disputed.

- **Talking is never blocked.** Shout all you like — half of an auction is the room.
- **Only this group.** Your DMs, and every other group, are untouched. The whole rest of the bot is one DM away.
- **Non-auction buttons** tapped in the group are refused the same way, as a pop-up alert.
- **Nothing is locked before it starts.** While the auction is still being set up, the group behaves normally.

An admin can turn it off for a particular auction with /afocus off; /afocus on its own says which way it is set.

10. Homework: what to read the night before

Every read-only view answers **before** the auction starts, and answers in a **DM** — because working out what your purse can reach, what the sets hold and what retention cost you is homework, and doing it in the group means doing it in front of the people you are about to bid against.

/arules	every number the auction will run by
/asets	what the pool holds, set by set
/apurse	every purse, including what retention cost
/asquad	who you already have
/ainfo	how far setup has got

In a DM the bot works out which auction you mean from the franchise you own. If you have teams in two auctions at once it will say so and name them, rather than guess — ask in that auction's group instead, where the question is unambiguous.

What does not work in a DM: /bid and /artm. Both belong to the room.

11. Every command you can use

Command	Who	What it does
/bid [amount] · /bd	owner + co-owners	Bid. Bare /bid bids the next minimum.
/artm yes no stand	the holder / top bidder	Answer an open Right To Match.
/aboard	anyone	The live board, with quick-bid buttons.
/ainfo · /amenu	anyone	Where the auction stands, and a button per view.
/arules · /asettings	anyone	Every rule and number this auction uses.
/apurse [team]	anyone	Every purse, max bid and squad count.
/asquad [team]	anyone	A squad as a table.
/asets	anyone	Every set and its state.
/anextset	anyone	The next set's players.
/anextplayer	anyone	Who is up next.
/asoldlist	anyone	Everyone sold, set by set.
/aunsoldlist	anyone	Everyone unsold.
/aretlock	anyone	Who kept whom; the retention window.
/apicks	anyone	The expansion pick order, and whose turn.

If you forget all of it: /ainfo puts every one of those behind a button.

12. Quick answers

"Why was my bid refused?"	The refusal says which rule, and prints the number that would have worked. Section 6 lists all of them.
"The board says my max bid is less than my purse."	That is the reachability reserve — money held back to fill the squad slots you still owe. Section 5.
"My /claim did not work in the group."	Focus mode: the auction is live. Use a DM. Section 9.
"Can my co-owner bid for us?"	Yes — but one of you at a time on a lot. Whoever bids first holds it; the next lot is open to either of you. Section 3.
"/bid 12 was refused, but /bid worked."	Direct bids are off in that auction: every raise is one step. Section 3.
"Somebody else's card ignores my taps."	Cards belong to whoever asked for them. Send the command yourself. Section 7.
"Can an admin bid for me if my phone dies?"	Yes, from the website console — and it is announced as an admin's bid, not as yours.
"I missed a player I needed."	Unsold players usually come back once, as the ✂ Accelerated set, before the auction finishes. /aunsoldlist has them.
"My squad is short at the end."	Squads under the minimum are topped up for free from whoever is still unsold, inside the squad and overseas caps.

Nothing in this guide needs admin rights. The auction's own numbers — purse, clock, caps, ladders — are whatever your admin set, and /arules always prints the live ones.